

ESTHER ADENUGA

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Computational Semantics and Pragmatics
- Multilingual and Low-Resource Natural Language Processing (NLP)
- Computer-Assisted Language Learning

EDUCATION

- **M.A. Computational Linguistics** Expected Jun. 2026
University of Ibadan Ibadan, Oyo, Nigeria
- **B.A. Linguistics/French (Combined Honors)** Jun. 2023
University of Ibadan Ibadan, Oyo, Nigeria
 - Thesis: Machine Learning Approach to Yoruba Named Entity Recognition

PUBLICATIONS

- Tyler A. Chang, Catherine Arnett, [...], **Esther Adenuga**, et al. **Global PIQA: Evaluating Physical Commonsense Reasoning Across 100+ Languages and Cultures**. arxiv.org/abs/2510.24081.
- Odunayo Ogundepo, Akintunde Oladipo, Kelechi Ogueji, **Esther Adenuga**, David Ifeoluwa Adelani, and Jimmy Lin. (2025). **Improving Multilingual Math Reasoning for African Languages**. arxiv.org/abs/2505.19848 (preprint).
- Pedro Ortiz Suarez, Laurie Burchell, Catherine Arnett, Rafael Mosquera-Gómez, [...], **Esther Adenuga**, et al. (2026). **CommonLID: Re-evaluating State-of-the-Art Language Identification Performance on Web Data**. arxiv.org/abs/2601.18026.

PRESENTATIONS

- **Esther Adenuga**, Akintunde Oladipo, Odunayo Ogundepo, Ismail Daud, Deborah Popoola, Adeyemi Praise, Okechukwu God'spraise, Olasoji Akindejoye, Abolade Daud, Raphael Afolayan, Sharon Ibejih, Cynthia Amol (2025). **Physical Commonsense Reasoning for West African Languages**. *Multilingual Representation Learning (MRL) Workshop, EMNLP*, November 2025, Virtual (poster).

RESEARCH AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCES

- **NLP Researcher/Data Insights Analyst** Feb. 2026 - present
Lanfrica Labs, Montréal, Quebec [🌐]
 - Contribute to [Lanfrica Insights](#), conducting data sourcing, metadata analysis, and structured reporting on African AI resources.
- **NLP Research Fellow** Mar. 2025 - May. 2026
The African Research Collective (TARESCo), Lagos, Nigeria [🌐]
 - Led TARESCo's submission to the [MRL 2025 Shared Task](#): developed the dataset creation guide, coordinated annotators, and co-authored the accompanying paper.
 - Conducted linguistic data annotation, model evaluation, and dataset design for multiple projects advancing NLP for African languages.
 - Contributed to research writing, experiment design, and preparation of manuscripts for publication.
- **Phonetics Intern** Jul. 2023 - Aug. 2023
Living Tongues Institute for Endangered Languages, Salem, Oregon, USA [🌐]
 - Collaborated with a team under Dr. Gregory Anderson to conduct phonetic annotation and analysis of Mundari language speech samples using Praat.
 - Participated in weekly meetings to review annotation progress and share findings on environmental sound patterns and their changes.

TEACHING EXPERIENCES

- **Online English Tutor** Jan. 2024 - Apr. 2025
Enrydvyne Educational Services, UK [🌐]
 - Provided one-on-one tutoring to 15+ GCSE and A-level students in English Language and Literature.
 - Prepared and submitted detailed daily and weekly progress reports on students' performance to stakeholders.
- **Teacher** Sept. 2024 - Mar. 2025
Apostolic Faith Elementary School, Lagos, Nigeria
 - Instructed 3rd and 4th grade pupils in Literacy and French using Montessori and digital learning techniques.
- **Teacher** Aug. 2023 - Aug. 2024
Zion Pilgrims Christ School, Bauchi, Nigeria
 - Taught Literature-in-English to grades 7-12 and French to 80+ elementary students, improving average performance from 50% to 70%.
 - Served on prefectship and Christmas event committees.

SKILLS

- **Technical:** Python, Praat, ELAN, Lexique Pro, L^AT_EX
- **Other Tools & Technologies:** Git, Github, MS Office Suite, Linux
- **Languages:** English (Fluent), Yoruba (Native), French (Basic), American Sign Language (Conversational)

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT AND CERTIFICATES

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|--|------|
| • ChatGPT Prompt Engineering for Developers, DeepLearning.AI | 2025 |
| • Linguistic Prompt Design Training, RWS | 2024 |
| • 120-Hour Teach English as a Foreign Language(TEFL) Certificate, Teacher Record | 2024 |
| • Crash Course on Python, Coursera | 2023 |
| • Introduction to Natural Language Processing, Analytics Vidhya | 2022 |
| • Introduction to Programming using Python, Analytics Vidhya | 2022 |

LEADERSHIP AND VOLUNTEERING EXPERIENCES

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| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Reviewer
<i>2025 Naija Voices Language Heritage Micro-Grants [🌐]</i><ul style="list-style-type: none">◦ Reviewed proposals supporting African language preservation, assessing project clarity, feasibility, and impact using a standardized evaluation rubric. | Jun. 2025 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Contributor
<i>Google Crowdsourcing, University of Ibadan Chapter, Oyo State, Nigeria</i><ul style="list-style-type: none">◦ Contributed to data labeling and validation for improved AI datasets. | Dec. 2022 - Dec. 2024 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Social Media Manager/Content Creator
<i>Publicity and Editorial CDS, National Youth Service Corps (NYSC), Bauchi State, Nigeria</i><ul style="list-style-type: none">◦ Managed the NYSC Bauchi Facebook page, covering events such as orphanage visits and community sensitization programs.◦ Served as Advertising Manager for a 10-member team that produced the Bauchi State NYSC Magazine (Batch B, Stream 1 & 2, 2023). | Jan. 2024 - June. 2024 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• District General Secretary
<i>Apostolic Faith Campus Fellowship, Oyo State, Nigeria</i><ul style="list-style-type: none">◦ Coordinated secretaries from six tertiary institutions in Oyo State, collating and submitting reports to the national office.◦ Organized events and programs in collaboration with the state president and outreach secretary. | Jan. 2022 - Jan. 2023 |